Vaishnavi Singh – Undergraduate Researcher (Technical AI Safety and AI Governance & Policy)

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Education

Singapore Management University

BSc, Computing and Law (with a 2nd Major in Political Science)

Relevant Coursework:

- Computing: Text Mining, Computational Thinking, Data Management, Business Process Solutioning, Cloud Technology, Web Development, Financial Markets Technology, Interaction Design, Software Product Management, Statistics for Data Science, Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, Application of AI in Fin Services,
- Law and Policy: Chinese Law and Policy, Contract Law, Criminal Law, Singapore Legal Systems, Law of Torts, FinTech Law, Intellectual Property Law, Ethics, Corporate Law, Privacy and Data Protection Law, AI Law and Policy, AI Ethics
- Political Science: Introduction to Political Studies, Policy Design and Analysis, World Politics

AI Safety and Policy Programmes/Fellowships

- Currently: Introduction to Cooperative AI Course, Cooperative AI Foundation, Georgia Tech AISI Technical Fellowship
- Past: Oxford ARBOx3 ML Research Bootcamp, Kairos Pathfinder Fellowship, BlueDot Impact's AI Safety Fundamentals (3x), ENAIS AI Safety Course (Alignment Track), Berkeley AI Safety Fellowship (Governance)

Research

From Object to Other: A Practical Theory of AI Moral Status and Personhood in Re-evaluating AI Safety Methods

- Authors: Vaishnavi Singh, Stephanie Choi, Desiree Junfijiah
- *Presented at The Foundations of Agentic Systems Theory (FAST) Workshop @ AAAI Workshop | 27th January, Singapore*

Experience

• Startup/NGO • Research • MNC

• **AI Safety Asia** — February 2026 – **Present**

Research Desk Volunteer — Remote | Singapore

- Drafting, editing and aiding with research via policy and news memo writing for a fast-moving policy thinktank
- Working on open projects focusing on societal impacts of AI, AI regulation developments and the future of work

• **Confide** Platform — May 2025 – **Present**

AI Governance Intern — Remote | Singapore

- Creating an extension of the compliance suite to fit the needs of European clients who wish to use AI systems in line with regulations across multiple jurisdictions including regulations from the EU, Singapore, China, New York, California.
- Working on a new product to address the incoming Singaporean Workplace Fairness Bill (2025).
- Created and worked on contract proposals for AI Auditing exercises.
- *Joint-project acting as my Final Year Project:* I am working on an AI Governance product that will have a company policy generator, AI evaluation tool and AI incident reporting. This started in January 2026 and will be a live product on the platform by mid-2026. I work directly with Ryan Dougherty, CPO.

• **Oxford AI Safety Initiative (OAISI)** — December 2025 – January 2026

Alignment Research Bootcamp Oxford — On-site | Oxfordshire

- Completed a two-week intensive curriculum based on ARENA that focused on transformer architectures, and mechanistic interpretability.
- Implemented technical alignment exercises covering reinforcement learning from human feedback and training dynamics.
- Developed a research project for final presentation involving machine learning safety engineering, focused on Scheming and Deception detection in evaluations (in-progress).

• **Berkeley AI Safety Initiative for Students (BASIS)** — January 2025 – January 2026

Research Fellow — Remote | California, U.S.A

- Attended 10 sessions that were seminar-style and discusses issues such as technical governance proposals, policy

designing for California in-light of stakeholder perspectives and more.
- Writing a research paper on state-aligned AGI and the effects on statecraft.
- Writing a research paper on AI consciousness and towards a working theory of legal personhood of AI under the mentorship of retired New York District Judge Katherine B. Forrest.
- Paper accepted to Foundations of Agentic Systems Theory (FAST) Workshop @ AAAI 2025

December 2023 – May 2024

Product Research Intern On-site | Singapore

- Proposed the conceptual frameworks of an AI tool for managing a whistle-blowing case considering multiple jurisdictions and potential liabilities to provide competent and quick directives for case managers
- Legal research into multiple legal and compliance issues regarding AI systems and whistleblowing in the EU and UK. Specifically focusing on the EU AI Act and other authoritative documents
- Focusing on the creation of a case manager assistance tool that utilised a node-based system to comprehensively display interlinked cases with investigative prompts, launched in February 2024

• **Perrin Institution @ University of Virginia** March 2025 – August 2025

AI Safety Research Associate Remote | USA

- Lead author for a propositional paper to the EU office in Estonia regarding the need for stronger action against Defence AI because of the EU AI Act's exception considering recent reports of AI use in conflict.

Senior Editor for AI Governance Remote | USA

- Writing articles regarding AI development, with a focus on US-China relations and self-regulation measures varying between 1,500 words to 2000.
- Topic spread includes DeepSeek and Chip Access, Democracy destabilisation through AI use, Autonomous Weapons, US-China relations affecting AI research, Taxonomies of AI Regulation, and more.

• **Yung Pung How School of Law** August 2024 – December 2024

Research Assistant for Assistant Professor Nydia Remolina On-site | Singapore

- Conducted extensive literature reviews on synthetic data applications in finance, healthcare, and urban planning identifying key use cases, benefits, and challenges to address data access gaps and enhance decision-making.
- Developed detailed analyses of research papers to aid the understanding synthetic data's impact on financial inclusion
- Investigated legal and regulatory frameworks, such as the EU AI Act, to assess the obligations and compliance requirements related to the generation and use of synthetic data by financial institutions.
- Compiled a list of notable synthetic datasets, including data sources, owners, applications, and usage contexts, to create a resource for stakeholders interested in synthetic data applications across multiple sectors.

• **Elegant Elefant** July 2024 – December 2024

Product Management & Business Development Intern (NDA) Remote | Singapore

- Legal research on the potential of AI systems having legal agency and personality to enact in negotiation procedures on behalf of their corporate principal entities
- Leading product design, structuring, approval initiatives with end-to-end implementation
- Conducting in-depth research on LLM models, search engines and other features to improve offerings

• **KPMG** May 2024 – November 2024

Technology Risk Advisory Intern On-site | Singapore

- Engaged in comprehensive technology advisory projects with a strong emphasis on AI governance & compliance
- Demonstrated strong stakeholder management by collaborating with senior team members to integrate AI industry insight, developing solutions and recommendations to address both internal and client challenges
- Supported the assessment of possible "Client Zero" technological solutions and researched various business requirements

as part of multiple internal AI committees and numerous regional workgroups.

- Reviewed and presented improvements on the alignment of technical specifications with AI-related client/internal needs whilst considering numerous local, regional and global frameworks and legislations like NIST RMF, EU AI Act, MAIGF, ISO/IECs etc.
- Developed AI solution prototypes and created AI risk matrix reports and scoring systems, ensuring robust risk management frameworks in line with hundreds of KPMG's AI controls
- Contributed to the creation of KPMG's AI Whitepaper focused on AI governance and compliance, and how businesses can enhance their understanding on the AI best practices
- Participated in client calls and discussions with thought leadership partners, gaining exposure to AI governance and compliance matters and contributing to knowledge sharing and strategic discussions
- Highly skilled in PowerPoint by working on numerous slide decks for internal committee initiatives and client engagements

• **CAREAI Labs (Singapore Management University)** May 2024 – September 2024
Research Assistant for Professor Swapna Gottipati On-site | Singapore

- Conducted in-depth literature reviews on nudging theory frameworks and ideated features including article segmentation, summary generation, mind-map creation. Used Claude 3.5, prototyping using Flask, JavaScript.

• **SMU Office for Overseas Centres** January 2024 – August 2024
Student Consultant On-site | Singapore

- Conducted 2 Business strategy projects under Vice President of Partnerships & Engagement Prof. Sun Sun, Executive Director Eddie Tritton, Jakarta Director Shoeb Khagda and Thailand Director Celine
- Prepared market assessment presentations to be presented to Singapore Management University leadership (President & Dean Prof Lily Kong, DBS CEO Piyush Gupta)

Leadership

NUS AI Safety Alignment (NAIA) – Pathfinder Fellowship Awarded
Executive Committee Member August 2025 – **Present**

- Launching two-track fellowships in NUS, one for AI Governance and the other for Technical AI Safety
- Spearheading a research paper reading group and assisting with funding and grant applications

SMU Artificial Intelligence Club
President May 2024 – May 2025

- Creating a formal research wing for academic research on AI, alongside a builders' team that is focused on AI projects
- 200+ attendees for our events on AI startups, an event with a technical focus with Jan.ai, a workshop on chatbot building with Google Cloud, and a fireside chat with the Microsoft CTO
- Organised fireside chats with numerous startups with niche AI products such as Finbots.AI, Pangaea Data, Flock.io
- Planned highly successful events such as one on AI Governance with IMDA, ST Engineering and more

SMU Product Management Club
Head of Events August 2023 – October 2024

- Planned the Product Management Experience (PME) that spanned 10 weeks and culminated in final prototypes and presentations, involving 50 selected students, 5 Product Managers from Carousell, Trust Bank, Singsaver & Foodpanda
- Planned the Product Networking Night alongside NUS, NTU, which involved 20 Product Managers, 200+ Students

SMU Legal Innovation and Technology Club
Law and Technology Director May 2022 – May 2023

- Conducted research for producing a monthly newsletter focusing on legal trends and developing legislations